Windows deployment and first robot test guide

This guide takes a new operator from a Windows laptop to deploying Team 3464's Java code on the robot's roboRIO 2.0, then checking the robot in stages. Start with a wired USB connection and leave the robot disabled until the electrical checks and mechanism references are confirmed.

Deploying copies and starts the program. Enabling permits actuator output. Imaging replaces the roboRIO operating system. These are separate actions. An ordinary code update does not require imaging.

Use the accompanying HTML version for offline reading or printing to PDF. The diagrams are connection illustrations, not photographs of this robot. Driver Station screenshots are official WPILib reference images; the installed version may look slightly different.

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1 What to bring

Laptop and software

Use a Windows 11 x64 laptop with administrator access for installations, its charger, reliable internet for initial downloads, and access to the team's GitHub repository. Windows on ARM is not supported by the cited 2026 WPILib installer. Install before arriving at the robot. WPILib installation

Tool	Needed for	What to install
WPILib 2026 with its VS Code and Java tools	Build and deploy this Java project	The project uses GradleRIO 2026.2.1 and Java 17; start with the matching WPILib 2026.2.1 installer
NI FRC Game Tools 2026	Driver Station, roboRIO utilities, USB drivers	Install the season-matched package and restart Windows
Git for Windows	Retrieve and update the team's code	Standard Git command-line installation

Tool	Needed for	What to install
Phoenix Tuner X	CTRE motor, CANcoder, Pigeon and CANivore inventory	Official CTRE distribution
REV Hardware Client 2	Identify and inspect SPARK MAX controllers	Version 2 for this project's 2026 REVLib
AdvantageScope	Live telemetry and saved log review	Useful during first testing; not required to deploy
Elastic or another existing team dashboard	Autonomous chooser and setup commands	Use the team's configured dashboard
PathPlanner editor	Inspect or edit paths	Optional; existing paths deploy with the project
SD image writer	Repair or initialize a roboRIO 2.0 microSD	Only if imaging is actually needed

A separate full LabVIEW development installation is not needed for this Java project. Game Tools supplies the Driver Station and associated robot tools. Game Tools installation

Software library versions are not device firmware versions. Keep the repository's `vendordeps` files rather than updating everything during first deployment. The inspected code uses Phoenix 6 **26.1.1**, REVLib **2026.0.3**, AdvantageKit **26.0.1**, PathPlannerLib **2026.1.2**, and PhotonLib **v2026.2.2**. Record actual firmware separately and check vendor compatibility before changing it.

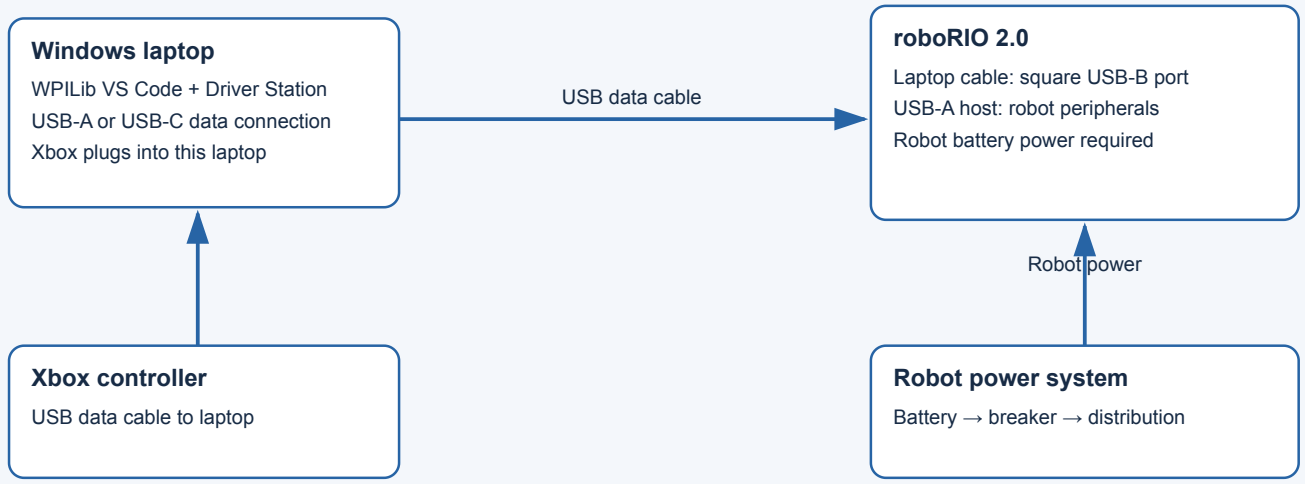
Cables and equipment

Item	Where it connects	Purpose
USB-A to USB-B data cable	Laptop rectangular USB-A → roboRIO square USB-B device port	Recommended first deployment connection; often called a printer cable
USB-C to USB-B data cable, or a suitable USB-A adapter	USB-C-only laptop → same roboRIO USB-B port	Alternative to the cable above
Xbox controller data cable	Xbox controller → laptop	Match the controller connector: USB-C or Micro-USB depending on model
USB data cable with USB-C at the SPARK end	Laptop → individual SPARK MAX	REV diagnostics; separate from the roboRIO deployment connection
Ethernet patch cable	Laptop/USB Ethernet adapter → approved robot network port	Alternative network connection
USB Ethernet adapter	Laptop USB → Ethernet cable	If the laptop has no Ethernet jack
microSD reader and spare appropriate card	Laptop → removable microSD	Only for imaging/recovery

Item	Where it connects	Purpose
Robot logging USB drive	roboRIO USB-A host port, if available	Preserve `.wpilog` recordings; don't displace the CANivore connection
Charged robot battery and approved robot stand	Robot power and support	USB does not power the robot

The roboRIO USB-B port is the laptop connection; its USB-A host ports serve attached devices. **Do not use an A-to-A USB cable between laptop and roboRIO.** roboRIO USB ports

First deployment connections



Stationary setup only. Disable and remove the laptop tether before floor driving.

Before moving cables, have someone familiar with the robot identify the roboRIO, CANivore, main breaker and radio. Do not unplug the CANivore to make room for the laptop: they use different roboRIO USB port roles.

2 Agree on the first session

Have one person operate the laptop and another watch the robot and keep the main breaker accessible. Ask the electrical team to bring the confirmed device inventory and the mechanical team to explain the turret/hood startup positions and intake travel endpoints.

The first session should accomplish these milestones in order:

1. Build the intended code on the laptop.
2. Connect to the powered but disabled robot.
3. Confirm bus assignments, devices and startup references.

4. Deploy and confirm that the intended program is running.
5. Observe sensors and errors while disabled.
6. Perform brief mechanism checks on an appropriate stand.
7. Test driving in a clear area using the robot network.
8. Only then test aiming, feeding and autonomous routines in a suitable shooting area.

Do not combine firmware updates, controller ID changes, code deployment and tuning into one unexplained change. Record each change and repeat the affected check.

3 Install the Windows tools

WPILib

1. Open the WPILib installation page and obtain the Windows x64 **2026.2.1** installer matching the project.
2. Mount the downloaded ISO in File Explorer and run `WPILibInstaller.exe`.
3. Install the development tools and WPILib's VS Code. Allow the installer to obtain its VS Code bundle while internet is available.
4. Open the installed **2026 WPILib VS Code**, not an unrelated editor shortcut.
5. Press `Ctrl+Shift+P`. Confirm commands beginning with `WPILib:` are available.
6. Do not accept an unrelated season/project upgrade prompt as part of this deployment.

Driver Station and device utilities

1. Follow the 2026 Game Tools installer instructions. Allow the required NI components and drivers to install, then restart Windows.
2. Open **FRC Driver Station** from Windows Start. In Setup, enter team **3464**. Leave it disabled.
3. Install Git for Windows. Open a new terminal and run `git --version`.
4. Install Phoenix Tuner X from CTRE's software page.
5. Install REV Hardware Client 2. The old client is not the correct tool for the project's 2026 REVLib. REV client guidance
6. Open each utility once while internet is available. Download any needed installer/firmware packages ahead of time, but do not flash devices just because a newer version is offered.

If school IT manages the laptop, resolve installation and network permissions beforehand. Avoid relying on a blanket firewall shutdown; configure the required applications with IT assistance.

4 Get exactly the intended code

Deploy the latest **`mentor-review`** code after the heading-reset and turret-limit changes have been merged. This guide assumes those changes and the two-CAN-bus configuration are included.

Expected configuration: turret limits **−80° to +80°**, hood limits **−223.5° to 0°** in encoder coordinates, inward manual turret recovery at either limit, and X heading reset that establishes forward consistently on both alliances. Fetch and update the laptop checkout before building.

First clone on this laptop

Open PowerShell and run one command at a time:

```
New-Item -ItemType Directory -Force C:\FRC
Set-Location C:\FRC
git clone --branch mentor-review https://github.com/FRC-Team-3464/2026-code.git
Set-Location C:\FRC\2026-code
git status --short
git branch --show-current
git log -1 --oneline
```

If GitHub asks for access, use the team's approved GitHub login flow. Never paste access tokens into shared screenshots or the guide.

If the repository already exists

```
Set-Location C:\FRC\2026-code
git status --short
```

If files are listed, stop and identify whose work it is before switching. Do not use `reset --hard`, force checkout or delete files to clear the warning.

With a clean checkout:

```
git fetch origin
git switch mentor-review
git pull --ff-only origin mentor-review
git branch --show-current
git rev-parse HEAD
git rev-parse origin/mentor-review
```

If the local branch does not exist, use `git switch --track origin/mentor-review`. If fast-forward fails, ask the software team to reconcile the branch. The two full revision values should match for an unchanged deployment of the remote branch.

Record the revision in the test-session notes. This is how to identify the deployed code later; a branch name alone can refer to different versions over time.

Inspect configuration before building

Open `C:\FRC\2026-code` in WPILib VS Code with **File** → **Open Folder**. The root contains `build.gradle`, `gradlew.bat`, `src`, and `.wpilib`.

Check:

- `.wpilib/wpilib_preferences.json`: team number 3464, project year 2026, Java.
- `Constants.java`: controller layout and profile. The inspected base selects `SINGLE_CONTROLLER`, Xbox, port 0.
- `Constants.java`: `kCANivoreBusName`. The base currently uses `"*"` for the first available CANivore and has a TODO for the confirmed name/serial. Confirm exactly one CANivore; do not guess a name.
- `ShooterConstants.java`: turret bounds −80° to +80°; hood minimum `Units.degreesToRadians(-223.5)` and maximum 0. These still require physical reference and clearance checks.
- `Drive.java`: heading reset uses the software gyro offset, and `getDriverHeading()` uses the driver-established reference after X.

REAL mode is selected automatically on the roboRIO by `RobotBase.isReal()`. **Do not change `kSimMode` to REAL to deploy.** Desktop simulation and physical robot detection are already separated.

This project's deployment script can automatically stage and commit changes on branches whose names begin with `event`. That behavior does not apply to `mentor-review`. Use the intended branch and do not rename it as a deployment workaround.

5 Build before approaching the robot

From a VS Code terminal in the project root:

```
.\gradlew.bat spotlessCheck build
```

Wait for **BUILD SUCCESSFUL**. The first build needs internet to download Gradle and project dependencies. This runs the project's tests as well as compilation; all tests in the updated checkout must pass.

If Java is not found, use the WPILib terminal/tools or set the current PowerShell session to the installed WPILib JDK. For a standard all-users installation, first verify the directory exists:

```
Test-Path C:\Users\Public\wpilib\2026\jdk\bin\java.exe
$env:JAVA_HOME = 'C:\Users\Public\wpilib\2026\jdk'
$env:Path = "$env:JAVA_HOME\bin;$env:Path"
java -version
.\gradlew.bat --version
```

Use the actual installation path if different. The project targets Java 17. Do not install arbitrary Java versions to chase errors.

If formatting or tests fail, save the first useful error and ask the software team to address it. Do not add `-x test` to bypass failures. When downloads fail, restore internet and retry; `--offline` only works once dependencies are cached.

Optional desktop preparation: run **WPILib: Simulate Robot Code** to become familiar with controls. Close the simulated Driver Station before connecting to the real robot. A passing SIM session does not confirm physical wiring or calibration.

6 Prepare and connect the robot

Before power

- Remove game pieces for initial tests and keep people clear of wheels, belts, intake racks and shooter.
- Have the mechanical team place the robot on a stable stand suitable for drivetrain testing. Wheel clearance alone does not make the hood/intake safe to move.
- Confirm the normal startup position for the turret and hood. This code zeros their relative encoders during initialization; restarting or deploying in an arbitrary position can establish the wrong zero.
- Have electrical confirm battery, breaker, roboRIO power and CANivore USB wiring.
- Put the laptop where the stop operator can reach it without reaching over the robot.

Do not enable merely because deployment succeeds. This robot's hood default command can request its zero-angle position once enabled even without pressing an aiming button.

USB connection for the first deployment

1. Keep Driver Station disabled.
2. Plug the cable's USB-B end into the roboRIO **USB device** port; plug the other end into the laptop.
3. Connect the Xbox controller to a different laptop USB port. It does not plug into the roboRIO.
4. Power the robot from its battery. Wait for the roboRIO to boot.
5. Let Windows detect the NI USB network device.
6. Open PowerShell and test:

```
ping 172.22.11.2
ping roboRIO-3464-FRC.local
```

The first address is the normal single-roboRIO USB address. A successful ping confirms basic reachability, not that the correct robot program is running. If USB ping fails, check power, data cable and Game Tools drivers first. WPILib network troubleshooting

A USB connection is convenient for stationary checks. Disconnect the tether while disabled before floor driving; never drive away with the laptop attached.

Ethernet and radio connection for floor testing

Use the robot's already configured network and have the electrical/network lead identify a normal data port. Do not connect the laptop to an unidentified powered radio port. Leave Windows IPv4 on automatic unless the team has a documented alternative.

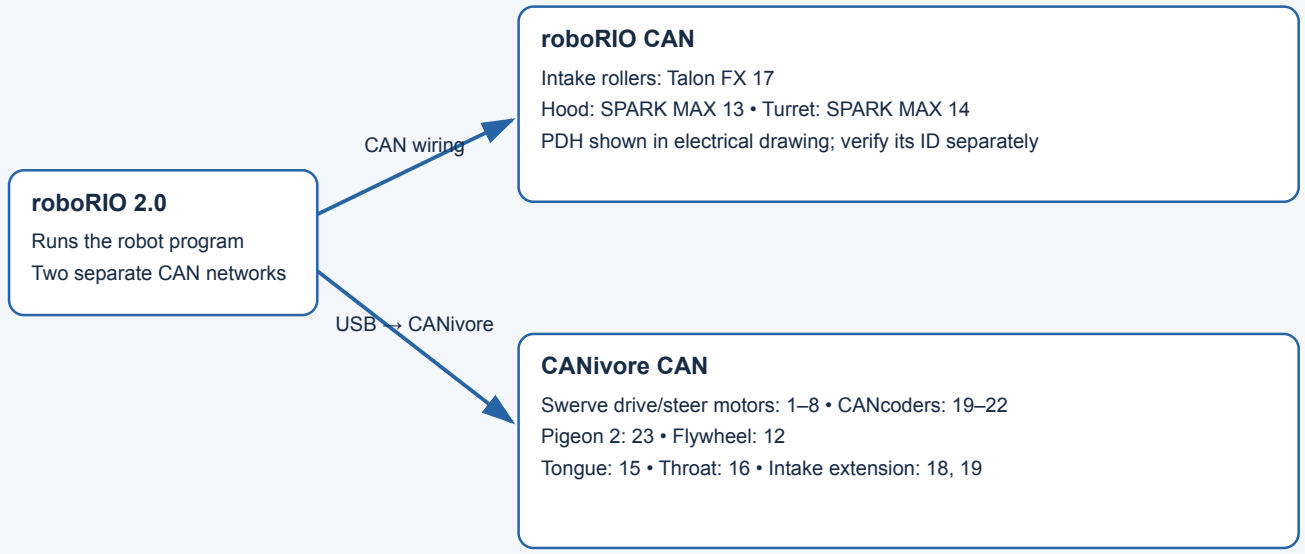
On the normal team network, try `roboRIO-3464-FRC.local`; the conventional team address is `10.34.64.2`. Direct laptop-to-roboRIO Ethernet without the radio can instead use link-local addresses, so that conventional address is not guaranteed. Confirm the actual interface address before changing settings. USB connectivity does not automatically provide direct access to every camera on the robot Ethernet network. Network troubleshooting

7 Confirm hardware before enabling

Deploying a program can apply controller configuration and reset relative encoders even while disabled. Record the existing device inventory first where practical. Keep motor-control/test features in vendor utilities inactive.

Two buses expected by the code

Expected CAN bus assignments



Software expectations, not an as-built drawing. Confirm device types, IDs, firmware and bus with electrical.

The laptop talks to the roboRIO. Robot code selects the appropriate CAN bus for each controller. The two CAN networks are separate; changing a CAN ID does not move a device between them.

Device	Expected ID	Expected bus	Exact code constant in `Constants.DeviceIDs`
Front left drive	1	CANivore	`kFrontLeftModuleDrive`
Front left steering	2	CANivore	`kFrontLeftModuleAzimuth`
Front right drive	3	CANivore	`kFrontRightModuleDrive`
Front right steering	4	CANivore	`kFrontRightModuleAzimuth`
Back left drive	5	CANivore	`kBackLeftModuleDrive`
Back left steering	6	CANivore	`kBackLeftModuleAzimuth`
Back right drive	7	CANivore	`kBackRightModuleDrive`
Back right steering	8	CANivore	`kBackRightModuleAzimuth`
Flywheel Talon FX	12, needs physical confirmation	CANivore	`kTurretFlywheel`
Hood SPARK MAX	13, needs physical confirmation	roboRIO	`kTurretHood`
Turret SPARK MAX	14, needs physical confirmation	roboRIO	`kTurretAzimuth`

Device	Expected ID	Expected bus	Exact code constant in `Constants.DeviceIDs`
Tongue indexer	15	CANivore	`kIndexerTounge`
Throat indexer	16	CANivore	`kIndexerThroat`
Intake roller Talon FX	17, needs physical confirmation	roboRIO	`kIntakeDrive`
Left intake extension	18	CANivore	`kLeftIntakePivot`
Right intake extension	19	CANivore	`kRightIntakePivot`
Front left CANcoder	19	CANivore	`kFrontLeftModuleEncoder`
Front right CANcoder	20	CANivore	`kFrontRightModuleEncoder`
Back left CANcoder	21	CANivore	`kBackLeftModuleEncoder`
Back right CANcoder	22	CANivore	`kBackRightModuleEncoder`
Pigeon 2	23	CANivore	`kPigeon2`

These are software expectations, not a signed-off inventory. Electrical must resolve IDs 9–11 and any extra devices. Record device type as well as number for both ID 19 entries; don't change either simply because their numbers match. Have the team verify device-type addressing before any renumbering.

Phoenix Tuner X inventory

1. Keep the robot disabled and connect Tuner to the roboRIO USB target or `172.22.11.2`.
2. Confirm the server connection and view devices on both the roboRIO and CANivore networks.
3. Capture device name/type, ID, bus, firmware, faults, and CANivore name/serial.
4. Identify each physical motor with the electrical team; a list of numbers alone cannot establish which mechanism is wired to it.
5. If the diagnostic server is unavailable, follow the official connection instructions with the software lead. Do not replace running robot code with diagnostic software without planning how to restore it.

Tuner connection instructions and CANivore setup.

REV inventory

Use a data-capable USB-C cable at each SPARK MAX and REV Hardware Client 2 to identify the hood and turret controller IDs and firmware. Have electrical arrange connections with power off, then supply power as required by the vendor procedure. Record before changing anything. Do not use the client's motor test controls during inventory. SPARK MAX connection and RHC2 troubleshooting.

If a controller type, bus or ID differs from the table, pause powered testing and reconcile the software/wiring. A green Driver Station connection does not prove that every controller is reachable.

8 Imaging only if the roboRIO needs it

Skip this section if the robot already boots with a compatible 2026 image and team number 3464. Reimaging is not part of a normal code deploy and can remove the current program/configuration on the card.

If imaging is necessary, have the robot lead preserve the existing card or backup first:

1. Install Game Tools and obtain the official `FRC_roboRIO2_2026_...img.zip` image from its SD Images location.
2. Turn robot power off and remove the microSD card. Put it in the laptop reader.
3. In a supported image writer, select that roboRIO 2 image and the correct removable card. Verify the destination carefully; writing erases it.
4. Write and verify, safely eject, and put the card back in the unpowered roboRIO.
5. Power up, connect by USB, then set team 3464 using the supported team-number utility/startup settings.
6. If Windows offers to format the written card, decline.
7. Deploy the robot program again and repeat device/reference checks.

roboRIO 2 imaging uses the microSD workflow, not the roboRIO 1 direct-imaging process. Follow the current illustrated official roboRIO 2 imaging instructions for exact utility screens.

9 Deploy the code

With successful build, confirmed startup positions, powered robot, and Driver Station disabled:

1. Verify the open folder is this repository, and the terminal shows `mentor-review`.
2. Close any active vendor motor-control sessions.
3. In WPILib VS Code press `Ctrl+Shift+P`.
4. Select **WPILib: Deploy Robot Code**.
5. Watch the terminal until the task completes successfully. Do not unplug power or USB during transfer.
6. Wait for the restarted program and check Driver Station messages.

Alternatively, from the project root:

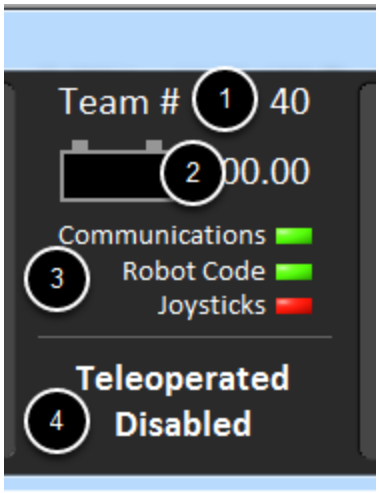
```
.\gradlew.bat deploy
```

Use one route, not both simultaneously. Do not use Java's standalone Run button or deploy a new template project. The repository deploy task also transfers `src/main/deploy`, including the PathPlanner assets. This project does not delete old remote deploy files automatically, so preserve the intended chooser/configuration instead of assuming the remote folder was wiped.

Official WPILib build and deployment commands.

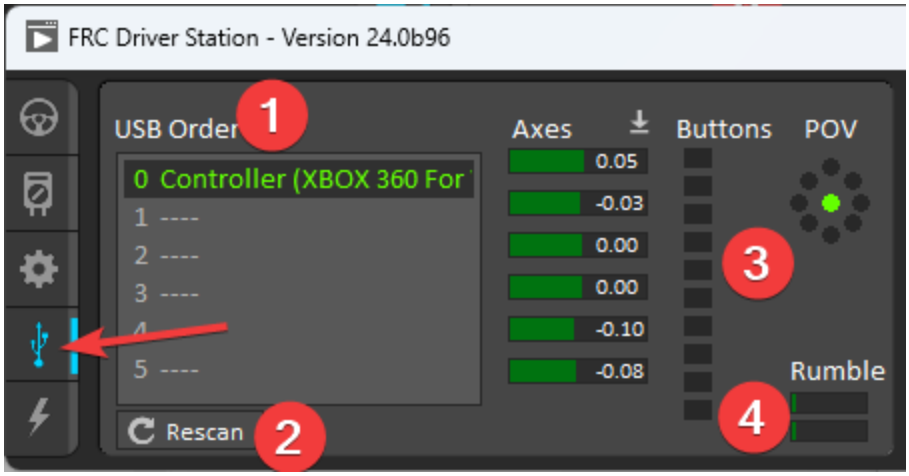
A successful deploy is not proof that the program stayed running. Check **Communications**, **Robot Code**, and messages while still disabled. Verify the build identity in the logged `GitBranch`, `GitSHA`, `BuildDate`, and dirty-state metadata when available. Do not rely on a moving dashboard widget as proof of the intended version.

10 Configure Driver Station and the Xbox controller



Official reference image: WPILib Driver Station documentation. Screen layout and example team numbers are illustrative.

1. Set team **3464**.
2. Select **Teleoperated**, keep **Disabled**, and confirm the expected alliance/station for the test.
3. In USB Devices, put the Xbox controller in slot **0**. Verify the axes, buttons and D-pad while disabled. Lock its slot if appropriate.
4. Release every button and center both thumbsticks before enabling.
5. Confirm Communications, Robot Code and controller recognition. Inspect messages rather than clearing unexplained errors.



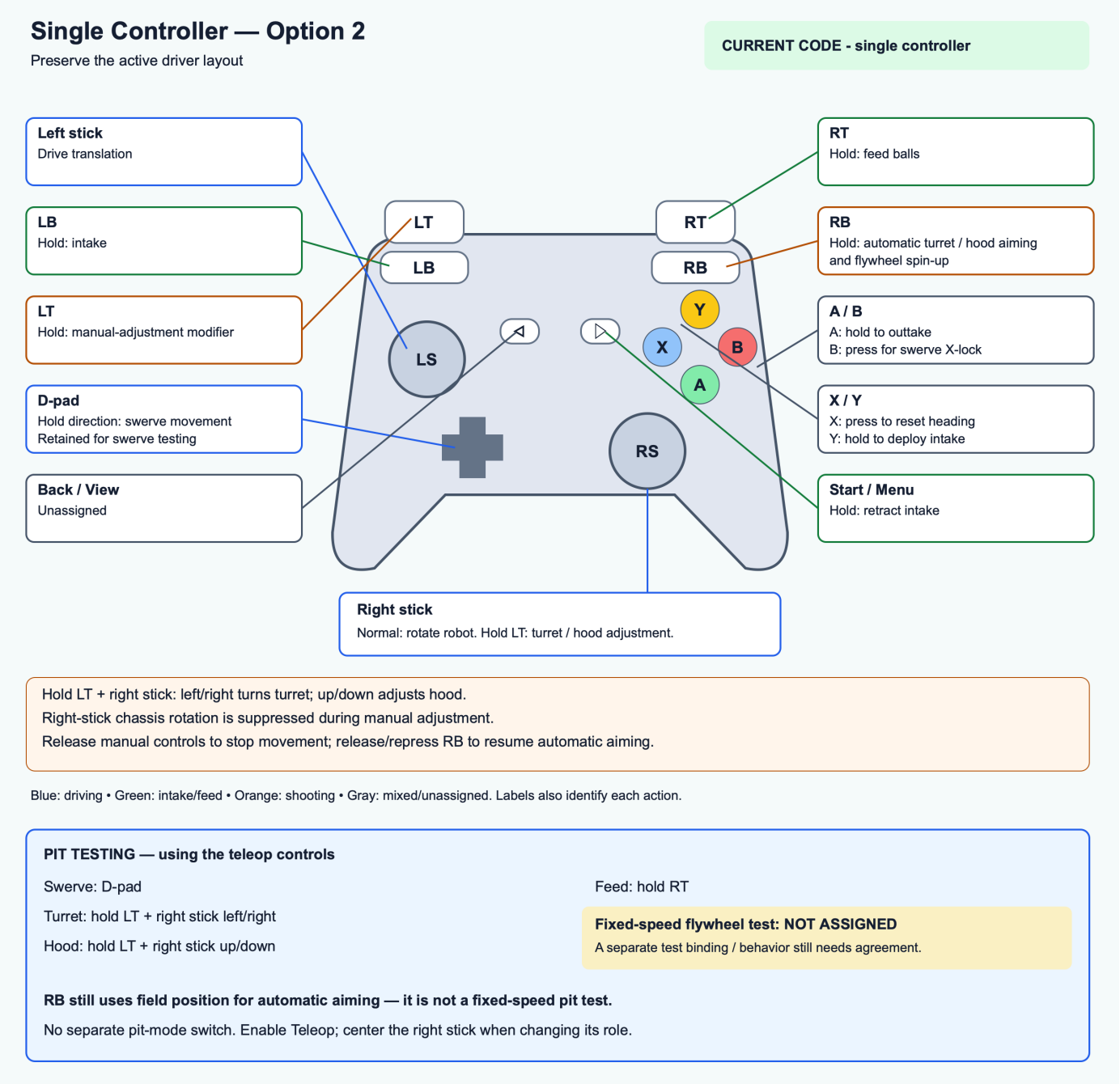
Official reference image from the same WPILib page; this illustrates controller slots, not this team's actual connected devices.

For ordinary disabling, use the Disable button or Enter with Driver Station in focus. Space is the Driver Station emergency stop during non-FMS testing and requires reboot before re-enabling. In an FMS match, use the field's team-station E-stop. Reboot only after identifying the cause, with controls neutral and the robot cleared. Driver Station controls

Driver Station Test mode is not a pit-shooting mode. This repository's normal controller bindings require enabled Teleop. Do not enable Test/LiveWindow or vendor motor controls to bypass those bindings.

11 Know the controls before enabling

The inspected base selects the single-controller layout. Confirm the actual checkout still does. These bindings are in `SingleDriverControls.java`; default subsystem behavior is in `DefaultControls.java`.



The repository controller picture is a quick reference. The table below calls out the behavior important during first testing.

Control	Action	First-test consideration
Left stick	Translate robot	Still active during manual aiming; keep centered during mechanism checks
Right stick horizontal	Rotate chassis	Changes role while LT is held
X	Heading reset	Fresh press in enabled Teleop establishes the current front as forward on either alliance

Control	Action	First-test consideration
B	Request swerve X-lock	Not a substitute for Disable
D-pad	Robot-relative directional driving	Commands 1 m/s, not a gentle variable-speed module jog
LB	Intake collection	Rollers can run while held
A	Outtake	Check direction with no game pieces
Y	Extend/deploy intake while held	Open-loop; release before physical endpoint
Menu/Start	Retract intake while held	Open-loop; observe both sides and avoid binding
RT	Feed indexer	Manual feed does not guarantee shooter readiness
RB	Automatic turret, hood and flywheel requests	Depends on field pose; can rotate turret and spin flywheel
LT plus right stick horizontal	Manual turret	Center right stick at role change; use brief small input
LT plus right stick vertical	Manual hood	Physical direction must be verified; no full-range sweep initially

Switching the right stick between chassis and manual aiming requires it to return near center. Manual override during RB requires releasing/repressing RB to resume automatic aiming. RB's flywheel request remains independent of manual turret/hood adjustment.

The hood can hold after manual movement while LT remains held, then return toward its default zero when LT/RB are released. **Releasing a mechanism button is not always a zero-output request. Use Disable if motion is unexpected.**

12 Test in stages

Stage A Disabled inspection

Pass criteria: stable robot program, known device inventory, plausible feedback, no unexplained disconnects.

1. Select **Do Nothing** in the `Autonomous` chooser and verify the displayed selection.
2. Keep Disabled. Review DS messages for missing devices, exceptions and image/library mismatches.
3. Connect the team's dashboard/AdvantageScope to the real robot, not localhost SIM.
4. Inspect turret/hood position and connection values, module angles, gyro connection and field pose. Relative zero on startup alone is not proof of correct physical alignment.
5. Have the team explain any sensor zeros, inversions or encoder offsets that have not been measured.
6. Save screenshots and the device inventory before powered movement.

Stage B First enable on the stand

Pass criteria: deliberate enable/disable, no unexplained motion, correct response to the stop operator.

1. Establish a clear area around all mechanisms. No game pieces.
2. Keep hands off controller buttons and sticks centered. Announce the first enable.
3. Enable Teleop briefly while the observer watches the hood and drivetrain. The hood may seek zero.
4. Disable immediately if anything moves unexpectedly, binds or makes abnormal noise.
5. Do not continue until the cause is understood. Do not try to fix a mechanical problem with the robot enabled.

Stage C Drivetrain checks

1. On the approved stand, use very small thumbstick requests and confirm all modules respond correctly. A wheel can point 180° away and spin oppositely due to swerve optimization; judge the combined rolling direction.
2. Test D-pad only after the team is ready for its fixed 1 m/s request. It moves the drivetrain, not just a selected module.
3. Verify B's X-lock request and Disable behavior.
4. If one module fights the others, disable and inspect its ID, encoder offset, inversion and wiring. Do not adjust several constants by guessing.
5. Disable, disconnect the USB tether, establish the radio/network connection, and move to a clear floor area before driving tests.
6. Use small translation and rotation inputs, verify robot-front convention (shooter is front), and record results.

Stage D Heading reset acceptance

Verify the software-offset heading reset on both alliances:

1. In a clear area, choose Blue while disabled, then enable Teleop with sticks neutral.
2. Turn to a known direction, stop, and press/release X.
3. Push forward gently: motion should follow the direction the robot front pointed at reset.
4. Stop, rotate the chassis, then push forward gently again. Travel should still follow the established field-relative direction, rather than continually following the robot nose.
5. Repeat X and confirm a new forward direction is established.
6. Disable; select Red and repeat. The same reset behavior should apply.
7. Record whether the estimated X/Y stays fixed at reset and heading stays stable afterward.

Heading reset also changes estimated rotation. Do not assume an arbitrary driver reset establishes a correct field pose for shooting. Re-establish the known field pose before automatic aiming.

Stage E Intake and indexer without game pieces

1. Confirm travel clearance and identify the extension/retraction endpoints with mechanical.
2. Use a brief Y request and check both intake extension motors move as intended; release well before the stop.
3. Use a brief Menu/Start request to retract. Stop if the sides disagree or rack motion binds.
4. Test LB and A briefly, confirming roller direction.
5. Test RT briefly and verify tongue/throat motion. Keep the shooter area clear even with no loaded game piece.
6. Disable between tests and record observations. There is no assumed automatic endpoint protection for these open-loop intake requests.

Stage F Manual turret and hood

1. Confirm physical zero, encoder conversion and clearance first. Inspect the deployed bounds, not just a diagram.
2. Keep the left stick centered and RB released. Hold LT, center the right stick, then apply a small horizontal request briefly.
3. Confirm physical turret direction agrees with increasing/decreasing reported angle. Disable if it does not.
4. Repeat with a small vertical request for the hood. Do not interpret the large negative hood encoder range as a physical tilt angle.
5. Observe what happens when the stick returns to center and when LT is released. Be prepared for the hood default return.
6. Limit checks must be planned by the mechanism lead. Do not drive into a mechanical stop to discover whether a software limit works.

Software should block outward manual requests at or beyond −80°/+80° and allow inward recovery. A valid physical zero and motor sign are prerequisites; the automated test alone cannot verify them.

Stage G Aiming and shooting

This is a separate test in an appropriate shooting area, with a confirmed field reference and a spotter. It is not a first-enable pit action.

- RB uses the estimated field pose. With missing tags or an incorrect pose, it can request a large turret turn and an inappropriate shot.
- LT does not turn RB into a fixed-speed flywheel test. Avoid that combination as a workaround.
- Establish and check a real field pose and alliance first. A dashboard pose assignment changes the estimate, not physical robot position.
- Start with no game pieces and observe the requested/measured turret, hood and flywheel values.
- Test feed only after the mechanism lead approves the aim, speed, target area and stop plan. RT is a manual feed request.

Stage H Autonomous

Only after driving, localization and mechanisms pass their checks:

1. Disable and select the intended URI routine on the dashboard. Confirm alliance.
2. Read `Auto Start/Placement` and the `Auto Start` field marker. Place the physical robot at that actual pose.
3. While disabled, use `Apply Auto Starting Pose`. Verify the estimate matches placement; do not click it to disguise a placement mismatch.
4. Clear the entire path and shooting area. These routines can operate multiple mechanisms and shoot.
5. Select Autonomous and enable only on the observer's readiness call. Keep the stop operator ready.
6. Disable after the run and inspect logs. A completed path does not prove a ball was collected or scored.
7. Return the chooser to Do Nothing before unrelated tests.

Practice mode automatically advances through match phases. Use it only after individual mode tests, not as the first test session.

13 Logs and evidence to save

This code publishes AdvantageKit telemetry and starts a REAL log writer. It expects normal roboRIO USB logging at `/U/logs`; confirm storage is present and a file is actually being written. Live telemetry alone is not a saved recording.

For each test, record:

Item	Record
Date and operator	
Deployed revision and build identity	
Driver Station and roboRIO image versions	
Controller layout and port	
CANivore name/serial and firmware	
Device inventory/screenshots	
Battery and test setup	
Alliance, mode and starting pose	
Test input and expected motion	
Actual motion and observed errors	

Item	Record
Log filename and approximate event time	
Pass, fail, or not tested	

Connect AdvantageScope using its live robot connection settings and the real robot address/team. See the team's AdvantageScope setup for the CAD model and logged fields. Download logs using the team's established robot-log transfer workflow or retrieve the logging drive after disabling and powering down. Keep DS logs as well as `.wpilog` files when diagnosing connection problems.

14 Troubleshooting

Symptom	First checks	Next step
No WPILib commands in VS Code	Correct 2026 WPILib VS Code installed/open	Repair installation; don't create a replacement project
Java not found	WPILib JDK path and terminal environment	Use installed Java 17; restart terminal
Dependency download failed	Internet, proxy and cache	Build online before robot session
Formatting/tests fail	First failure in terminal/report	Resolve with software team; don't skip tests
USB ping fails	Robot power, cable data capability, NI drivers	Try known-good cable/port and inspect Windows network devices
USB IP works but hostname fails	Team number/mDNS and competing network adapters	Use official network troubleshooting; don't reimage immediately
Communications green but Robot Code red	Crash messages, incompatible image/library, incomplete deploy	Save error output and inspect program startup
Controller not recognized	Laptop USB connection and DS slot	Rescan while disabled, lock port 0, verify every axis
Robot Code green but motors disconnected	Device type, ID, bus, CANivore USB, power	Electrical inventory; green code is not a CAN health check
Tuner shows only one bus	Target selection, CANivore detection and wiring	Check both networks explicitly
Hood moves when enabling/releasing LT	Default zero request and physical startup reference	Disable; verify mechanism reference and expected return
Right stick seems inactive after LT	Neutral rearming requirement	Center both right-stick axes before changing role
D-pad does nothing in DS Test	Bindings are Teleop-only	Use the staged Teleop procedure, not bypass controls

Symptom	First checks	Next step
Turret turns unexpectedly on RB	Incorrect field pose/alliance/reference	Disable; do not repeatedly retry automatic aim
Turret can't recover inward	Encoder reading, requested direction, connection and physical obstruction	Disable; inspect logs, physical reference and deployed configuration
Voltage drops/reboots	Battery, connections, load and CAN faults	Electrical inspection before continuing
No autonomous choices/paths	Startup errors and deployed assets	Confirm build, files, chooser and correct code version
No saved log	USB storage/path/capacity and logger errors	Confirm actual file creation before next useful test
E-stopped	Cause of emergency and robot state	Resolve cause before reboot and deliberate re-enable

Do not turn the main breaker off while flashing firmware or writing an SD image. For an immediate physical hazard, stopping the robot takes priority; investigate possible incomplete updates afterward.

15 End the session and recover a failed deployment

1. Disable and release all controls.
2. Save logs, screenshots and failed-test details.
3. Power down before moving the robot, removing the logging drive or servicing mechanisms.
4. Record the final deployed version and unresolved issues for the next operator.
5. If a new program does not start or behaves incorrectly, have software select a known-good version compatible with the **current wiring** and redeploy while disabled. Older code that assumes a single CAN bus may not be a suitable rollback.
6. Recheck startup references after any program restart. Do not assume relative encoders retained their physical zero.

16 Quick checklist at the robot

- [ ] Laptop tools installed and project builds successfully.
- [ ] Intended remote code fetched; branch and deployed revision recorded.
- [ ] Controller layout, ±80° turret bounds, hood bounds and heading-reset configuration checked.
- [ ] Electrical inventory, both buses and unknown IDs resolved for powered tests.
- [ ] Turret/hood startup references and intake clearance confirmed.
- [ ] Robot supported, game pieces removed, stop operator ready.

- [ ] USB connected to roboRIO USB-B; Xbox connected to laptop.
- [ ] Team 3464; Driver Station disabled; communication verified.
- [ ] Deploy completed; correct program identity and messages checked.
- [ ] Do Nothing selected; controller slot 0 verified with controls neutral.
- [ ] Disabled sensor checks complete before first enable.
- [ ] Mechanisms and driving tested in stages; logs saved.
- [ ] Automatic aiming/autonomous deferred until field pose and clear test area are ready.

Reference images and official instructions

The two Driver Station screenshots are reproduced from WPILib documentation with links beside them. The cable and CAN diagrams are schematic illustrations created for this guide. They are not as-built electrical drawings. Existing controller art comes from this repository.

- WPILib installation and supported platforms
- NI FRC Game Tools installation
- roboRIO USB port roles
- roboRIO 2 microSD imaging
- WPILib deployment
- Driver Station screens and operation
- Network troubleshooting
- Phoenix Tuner connections
- CANivore setup
- REV Hardware Client 2